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June 24, 2026, Volume 36 Number 25

GABRIOLA

Sounder

Gabriola's Weekly Community Newspaper



GABRIOLA GRADS OF 2026! June is when we celebrate graduations. Students from Gabriola graduating from Grade 12 had their proms earlier this month, and photos were sent in to the Sounder to recognize this. On the left: Nico Bonder graduated from Aspengrove. Middle photo, NDSS students (L-R): Leo Dewarle, Matteo Halpin, Harper Vanderwaak (Grade 11), Nick Wishinski, Ellie Smith, Rhiannon Ross, Abby Alexander, Alex Jellis, Olivia Payne. Right photo: Naomi Cripps at her graduation ceremony.

Submitted photos



Derek Kilbourn photo

STUDENTS GRADUATING FROM GRADE 7 AT GABRIOLA ELEMENTARY WERE CELEBRATED WITH A LEAVING CEREMONY ON JUNE 19. With 27 students, it is one of the largest Grade 7 Classes to depart Gabriola Elementary. They are: Sofie Betmanis, Cece Bishop, Enrique Borste Torres, Adelene Bugeaud, Daven Cody, Ryleigh Contreras, Sage Forbes, Gerda Garbe, Presley Graham, Callum Heughan, Olivia Hobson, Savannah Johnson, Abigail Macmillan, Josephine McCreath, Logan McIntosh, Koa Mohammed, Luca Molloy, Max Mort, Teo Mullaey, Wesley Pepper-Smith, Maple Reid, Dash Scott, Bo Smith, Carl Soderberg Gillespie, Jakob Svensson, Jayden Van Den Heuvel, and Ariadne Welsby.

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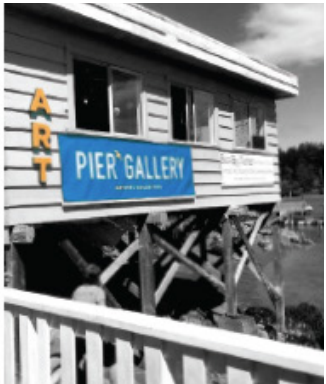
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Derek Kilbourn photo

GRAND RE-OPENING - Snuneymuxw Elder and Knowledge Keeper David Laxiya Bodaly with staff and owners at the Grand Re-Opening of Nature Spirit Earth Market, held on June 21 this past week. The Gabriola-owned and operated business moved spaces within the Madrona complex this past winter, gaining space to expand their offerings.

Happy Canada Day!

Grateful for this beautiful country we call home
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Trust Council divided on moving forward with Trust Policy Statement work until end of term

New TPS adoption scheduled for 2029, 10 years from the when the review started

Hope Lompe
Local Journalism Initiative Reporter, Gabriola Sounder

Adoption of the Trust Policy Statement is now expected for June 2029, 10 years and three terms from the start of the policy statement amendment project.

Trust Council adopted the new project charter following three motions on policy statement work plans for staff – including one that proposed stopping that work all together.

All three motions failed on tie votes.

“I consider it quite offensive that this motion would be made on such a significant project that has such large

ramifications for the Trust Area,” said Gabriola Trustee Tobi Elliott, speaking to the motion that asked all work be suspended on the policy statement, except engagement with First Nations.

“[It] is so important to the mandate to upholding the mandate of the Trust. We need to have these conversations to get to a better draft.”

The motion to stop all work on the policy statement was made by Saturna Island Trustee Lee Middleton, following two failed competing motions, also on staff policy statement work plans.

The first was to defer any further work on the Trust Policy Handbook and

Implementation Plan until the Islands Trust Council has given second reading to the new policy statement, made by Gambier Island Trustee Joe Bernardo.

The handbook is a reference for elected officials on how they could implement the policy statement policies in official community plans (OCP) and land use bylaws (LUB), while the implementation plan lays out how the policy statement will be integrated into the workings of the Trust once adopted.

Trust Council discussed both documents extensively earlier in the meeting.

This failed in a tie vote,

after a recount. On first count, the motion passed with nine in favour, nine opposed and one abstention. Absentees are counted as in-favour per the Local Government Act.

Following the re-count it was revealed the trustee who was counted as abstained, actually was not in the meeting at the time of the count. He was corrected to be not counted, and the motion failed with nine in favour and nine opposed.

Immediately after, Trustee Elliott made her motion, opposite to Berardo’s. She moved that staff to continue refining the policy statement companion handbook, and undertake internal review of an analysis with Planning Services staff.

This motion also failed, this time with 10 in favour and 10 opposed.

The result from both failed motions is that staff would continue their work “in a non-urgent fashion,” said Chair Laura Patrick.

Following the failed competing motions, Trustee Middleton made his case

that all work be stopped on the policy statement, until a newly elected council take it on, with the exception of staff’s engagement with Indigenous governing bodies and other governments.

“There’s a strong foundation, but we’ve been told we cannot finish this work. It won’t be possible for us to finish this work this term,” he said.

“I’m proposing we just stop work on it...and we allow the work to continue under a design authored by the next council.”

While final adoption of the policy statement will not be completed before the end of term, in part because First Nations consultation has not finished and the Ministry of Housing and Municipal Affairs would need up to a year with the document for final approval, second reading could still happen before the end of term.

“To abandon that course now is ludicrous, and I think it would waste a lot of time and energy that’s already been put into it. Many people

are waiting to see this draft advance. It’s not about getting it done now, we know that, but the work needs to continue,” said Elliott

Several others spoke both for and against the motion to suspend all work. It was noted that it could take years for another Trust Council to pick up the project again, which has already had so many resources put into it since its inception. Others thought this would be a good pause on the project, given how much concern they have heard in their communities.

The motion failed in the third tie vote of the day with eight in favour, 10 opposed, and two abstain, counted as in favour.

“If we are voting in ways where we are splitting down the middle, maybe we all ought to listen to each other a little bit better,” said North Pender Trustee Deb Morrison.

“It is not okay that we’re making decisions with very equal split, we’re not getting anywhere if we’re just dividing the vote and pushing forward.”

RDN staff propose public engagement on nearly three decade old noise bylaws

Staff say they will involve and consult with Islands Trust

Hope Lompe
Local Journalism Initiative Reporter, Gabriola Sounder

Regional District of Nanaimo (RDN) staff are working toward a review of its noise control bylaws, with the intention to gather feedback from residents on current bylaws before bringing forward changes.

At the Jun. 11 Electoral Area Services Committee (EASC) meeting, board members heard staff visions for the bylaw review process, which could add areas F and H to the service. Noise regulation bylaws are in place for all Electoral Areas except those two.

Each Electoral Area has a noise regulation bylaw adopted between 1997 to 1999, with EA B’s noise bylaw adopted in 1998. The review could include developing a new uniform noise control bylaw, region wide.

“Given the age range of these by-laws, a comprehensive review is warranted, including staff analysis, legal reviews, public engagement, and a consideration for possible amendments,” said Tina Mercier, Manager of Bylaw Services at the meeting.

She adds staff will incorporate all the outstanding board motions identified related to noise in the project review. However, two board members said their outstanding noise-related motions were not in the report, and so it was referred back to staff to incorporate those before moving forward with the engagement plan.

Should it pass at the next meeting, each Electoral Area will get drop-in open houses

to “educate, inform and survey residents,” on their noise bylaws. Feedback will also be taken from surveys, and advertised through news releases, newspaper ads, social media, the RDN Get Involved RDN web page, and Project e-newsletters.

In Electoral Area B, Gabriola is also subject to the Islands Trust Gabriola Island Land Use Bylaw. That bylaw also has stipulations for noise on home occupations:

“No home occupation may create or permit noise which disturbs persons, or is clearly audible, off the lot on which the home occupation is conducted,” reads the bylaw.

The Gabriola LUB also says that the RDN noise bylaws for Gabriola are applicable.

Mercier writes that staff will involve and consult with Islands Trust as part of the noise control bylaw engagement process in Electoral Area B.

On Gabriola Island Islands Trust regulates land use (zoning, permitted uses, siting, etc.) through the Gabriola Land Use Bylaw.

The RDN provides regulatory services, including noise control and enforcement through the Electoral Area B Noise Bylaw

“This split/link is commonly described as Islands Trust is what you can do on land, RDN is how and when certain activities are regulated,” she writes.

Generally, she says if the noise is associated to a permitted use determined by Islands Trust, the RDN would not typically enforce on it. However, If the use

exceeds what is permitted, and the RDN receives a noise complaint, they will investigate it.

“The two jurisdictions RDN Bylaw Services and Islands Trust Bylaw Enforcement consult together when there are links/overlaps like this, including noise,” she writes.

“We meet regularly to discuss bylaw matters.”

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Pat Burns/Harrison/ Canso area:

- Dirksen/Stephens.
- Easthom near Harrison.
- Lewis Close off Stephens.
- Crestwood/South Road.
- Harrison and Pat Burns.

Whalebone area:

- Broadview and Barrett.
- Tashtego and Whalebone.

Taylor Bay/Berry Point:

- Twin Beaches Centre
- Ricardo water tower
- Malaspina and Lloyd Crescent.
- Berry Point Road across from Camp Miriam.

South End:

- Tyee and Blueback.
- Commodore/Silva Bay Rd
- Bevmaril at South Road.
- Garland, behind the Community Hall.

Mid-Island:

- North Road at Barrett.
- North Road at Peterson.
- North Road at Horseshoe Road mailboxes.
- Buttercup.
- South Road at Peterson.
- South Road at Stokes.
- South Road at El Verano.
- Ferne Road at South Road.
- Coats Road at South Road.

Phase 4:

- Chelwood and Hemlock.

Ferry:

- Green box by the Descanso Bay Terminal
- Ferry Turnaround (blue Sounder box)
- White box outside the Nanaimo Harbour terminal

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Gabriola Sounder office

The Gabriola Library

Ground Up Café

Village Liquor Store

Gabriola Community Health Centre (downstairs)

Gulf Island Seaplanes

Gabriola Golf Club

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Questions? Call 250-247-9337 or email sarah@soundernews.com or derek@soundernews.com



Please only take the copy needed for reading this week's edition

Bring on summer.

We’re now officially into summer, and from now till December, the days start getting shorter.

The cisterns will get lower and lower.

The sunsets on beaches will start getting better and better.

Sometimes because there’s a fire burning somewhere in BC.

Another reminder - Gabriola has entered into Extreme Shutdown, where there are a number of restrictions on what powered equipment can be used, and what precautions are required to do so. More on that on page 11.

Back to those beaches.

Sun, sand, some kids digging holes, and others floating out to sea, while caregivers dive into their attempt at a summer novel. Or nap.

Yes, there’s lineups at the ferry. And the village core is busy and filled with lots of people. But that’s tourism in a community which values our visitors. They’ll soon know, you can’t beat Gabriola as a place to be in the summer.

Editorial



SMILES & SNARLS

SMILE - Happy ending to a sad story. Many thanks to J. Jack McQuaid for gifting a beautiful canoe to Don on Brickyard. Thanks so much Jack.

~ Li Small

SMILE - to the Foley family for sending in the cavalry to rescue us, when we recently ran out of water. We are so grateful to you.

- Grateful Pat Burns resident.

SMILE - Dear Gabriola, we want more entertaining snarls. We know you can do it!

- From the person in the trench coat

To submit a smile or snarl, call 250-247-9337 or email derek@soundernews.com

Submissions subject to editing.

ORGANICS, GARBAGE, & RECYCLING SCHEDULE	
RECYCLING & ORGANICS: Wed. June 24/Thu. July 9	
GARBAGE & ORGANICS: Thu. July 2/Thu. July 16	

Gabriola-Nanaimo Ferry Schedule IN EFFECT APRIL 1, 2026	
FERRY TRAVELLERS SHOULD BE AT THE TERMINAL 10 MIN PRIOR TO SAILING TO ENSURE THEY ARE ABLE TO BOARD THEIR INTENDED SAILING.	
LEAVE GABRIOLA	LEAVE NANAIMO
• 5:15 AM MON-FRI ONLY	5:45 AM MON-FRI ONLY
• 6:20 AM	
• 7:05 AM MON-FRI ONLY	• 6:55 AM EXCEPT SUNDAYS
• 7:35 AM EXCEPT SUNDAYS	7:35 AM EXCEPT SUNDAYS
8:10 AM	• 8:10 AM
• 8:45 AM	• 8:45 AM
9:20 AM	• 9:20 AM
• 9:55 AM	9:55 AM
10:35 AM	• 10:35 AM EXCEPT WED (DG)
• 11:15 AM	11:15 AM
11:50 AM	• 11:50 AM
• 1:10 PM	1:10 PM
1:45 PM	• 1:45 PM
• 2:20 PM	2:20 PM
2:55 PM	• 2:55 PM
• 3:30 PM	3:30 PM
4:05 PM	• 4:05 PM
• 4:40 PM	4:40 PM
5:15 PM	• 5:20 PM
• 5:55 PM EXCEPT WED (DG)	6:30 PM
7:05 PM	• 7:40 PM
• 8:15 PM	9:25 PM
• 9:55 PM	• 10:30 PM EXCEPT WED
• 11:00 PM EXCEPT WED	11:30 PM
SAILINGS WITH • ARE THE GABRIOLA-BASED SHIP DC: THESE SAILINGS ARE REPLACED BY DANGEROUS CARGO SAILINGS. NO OTHER PASSENGERS OR VEHICLES ARE PERMITTED	
<- SCAN THE QR CODE TO CHECK THE GABRIOLA FERRY CAM	
THE FERRY WEBCAM HAS BEEN MADE AVAILABLE TO THE COMMUNITY THROUGH THE VOLUNTARY EFFORTS OF "THE LUNCH BUNCH", A SMALL GROUP OF RETIRED LOCAL RESIDENTS WHO MEET FOR LUNCH ONCE A MONTH, AND WANTED TO GIVE SOMETHING BACK TO GABRIOLA AND THE COMMUNITY.	

Letters to the Editor

Responses to Summer Rain coverage in Gabriola Sounder

Dear Editor,

A letter written to the Island’s Trust by Luke van den Horst struck a chord with me and I thought, that is exactly the kind of letter I would have written 30 or 40 years ago.

Dan Foley’s service is an essential service, and likely to be more so as time goes on. We all do the best we can to have and maintain our own source of water with drilled wells and catchment systems. But we all know that both can be unreliable due to lack of rain, resulting in lower water table, or our systems can fail unexpectedly, as mine did a year ago when copper water pipes under the house rotted out and drained the cisterns before I knew there was a problem. I have lived here for 56 years, am 92, and have had need for Dan’s service many times over the years. I could always rely on him and his team.

Water is essential. We can’t live without it for our daily routine.

As a community, we need to rally behind Dan and Summer Rain. Many of us depend on his service. If noise is a problem with neighbours, would an electric pump resolve that? If it is too expensive for Dan, let’s make it a community project. We can, and have, raised money in the past for essential community services. Let’s do it!

Trucking water from Nanaimo makes no sense for the needs of the community (factoring in time and expense). What are complainants going to do when they need water? Other complaints don’t rate in comparison to the needs of the community. Forty-nine complaints? They can’t all be immediate neighbours.

In community spirit, let’s go Gabriola.

~ Elma (Em) Gavin

I would like to direct this letter, not so much to the Gabriolian community, but directly to the complainer(s) of Summer Rain. I have no idea who you are, other than a reference that you are a Summer Rain neighbour. At this point I’ll make two assumptions: 1) Being noise sensitive, you bought your property having no idea that our island’s essential water service is not a silent undertaking. 2) Having discovered that a water service is not silent, you now have no idea that when you threaten Summer Rain, you are threatening the water security of every person on this island. We are a dry island. This is serious business. Please consider the following inevitable scenario: If you were to succeed in shutting down Summer Rain, then the next time Gabriola’s ferry docking facility breaks down, you will have succeeded in cutting off the entire island’s access to drinking water. Our cisterns go dry in the summer. Have you considered how your island neighbors would feel about your shut down success and all the negative consequences there in. Perhaps you have not considered that you are trying to make your problem....everyone’s problem.

Please consider the alternative: Rather than trying to off-load your unhappiness onto every islanders doorstep, you could solve your problem, yourself. You could donate an electric pump to summer rain as both a solution to your problem and as compensation for the \$50,000 our essential service has had to waste on retaining water security for this island. Or you could set up a go-fund-me/fundraiser. Your fellow islanders would applaud your new understanding of the bigger picture.

“Me me me” is the mode of operandi that is disabling our planets ability to sustain itself. Making choices for the greater good is the way to turn that around.

~ Diane Lafontaine

It’s hard work being a community, as an Indigenous elder once said. Especially in the realm of getting along as a community and accommodating each other’s different needs, priorities and realities.

And so I wasn’t surprised when I read the *Sounder* story about the BC Supreme Court’s ruling on the bylaw infraction case against Dan and Debra Foley and the business they’ve run on Gabriola for 25 years. I was only sad.

It’s hard to fathom how 50 complaints could have been filed against the Foleys and their water business since 2020, and for this to have become so fraught. I biked past the place last weekend and noticed that more tall board fencing has been erected along Stalker Road, seemingly to mitigate the unavoidable noise of pumping water to support an essential community service. I also noted the lack of required shed setback. The Foleys have cleverly let some of the board fencing do double duty as the back wall for some storage shedding; my frugal mother would have approved.

Still, at least some of the neighbours take a different view, and have exercised their right to file complaints. Warren Dingman, the bylaws enforcement manager with Islands Trust has done his job, and the rule of law has run its course. There remains, however, the much older laws that underpin being a community on shared land like this island – such as mutual respect and the law of good neighbourliness.

As one of the Foley’s grateful customers, I’d be happy to attend, and provide moral support to, a neighbourhood meeting to resolve the impasse before the Foleys are driven out of business.

That done, maybe we can then come together to get Stalker Road paved.

~ Heather Menzies

Letters continued on page 10

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR POLICY - *The Gabriola Sounder* welcomes letters to the editor for publication. Letters must be signed and a phone number included so the writer’s identity can be verified. *The Sounder* reserves the right to edit letters for legal considerations, taste, and brevity. Please try to keep your letters under 300 words to ensure your ‘Letter to the Editor’ appears as close to its original form as possible. Thank you to everyone who took the time to send us comments. Keep your input coming.

Around the Island

Weekly joke: What did the beaver say to the maple tree?

A reminder that the Library’s summer reading program is for all ages. Drop in and talk to the always-friendly library staff to find out all about it.

Gabriola’s in Extreme Shutdown. This doesn’t mean what it did 10 years ago - but it does still mean to practice extreme caution with any powered equipment. A handy guide from the GVFD (last updated on June 12, 2026) is included on page 11 of this *Sounder*. For a digital version, and to keep up to date on the fire rating, check Gabriolafire.ca

July 1 is fast approaching. Check the events calendar for all the times. Cruisers parade. Potato cannons. The Gabriola Museum. There’s plenty to do on Canada Day.

This is the last week of school. Which will mean that the school zone in front of Gabriola Elementary will take a summer break - though the playground zone in front of Huxley Park will not. Please continue doing 30kph through there, especially as there will be more people in the park through the summer months.

Mark July 4 on the calendar. The Munu Canoe fundraiser to support Snuneymuxw First Nation youth Tribal Journey will be at x”cumi:lucun / Twin Beaches. See this week’s event calendar for the necessary times and such.

Joke answer: Nice gnawing you.

GABRIOLA WALKING GROUP

Wednesday walks begin promptly at 10:00am.

Dogs on leash please.

June 24 - Park Jeanette. Walk 707 Park Trails.

July 1 - Park Ravenskill Orchards. Canada Day 707 Park Walk.

July 8 - Park S’ul-hween X’pey (Elder Cedar) Nature Reserve. Walk Area Trails.

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BIKE RODEO - Scott Colbourne, Programming Coordinator for the Gabriola Recreation Society and certified bike coach, hosted a bike rodeo earlier in June for the



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Derek Kilbourn photos
students at Gabriola Elementary, aided by Sage Wolokoff-Drader. Students are taken through a safety course, to practice the different hand signals and manoeuvring skills. New this year to the bike sessions was a ride up to the hill beside the school field, where students were able to practice ascending and descending skills.

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The Friends of the Library wish to thank the following people for assisting with our 2026 Book Sale:

All the volunteers who loaded, drove and unloaded hundreds of boxes of books; all the volunteers who unpacked, sorted and organized hundreds of boxes of books; all the volunteers who helped dismantle the sale; Gabriola Sounder; Community Hall; Kendra Runnalls and the VIRC staff; Judith Madsen, Sophie Sonoko Gray, Mona Kaino (book marks); Gallery Press; Lions Club (tables); Karate Club (set up); Neal Brown (Arbutus Books); Lois Caldwell (floral arrangements); Robert Sharman (driver); Shea Can Bake and Taco Papi.

Most of all we thank the community who donated all the books and then came out on Saturday and Sunday to enjoy the Book Sale and keep the volunteer cashiers busy. All proceeds from the Book Sale go to support programmes and services of our Gabriola Library.



LIBRARY LOVERS



GIRO is moving to SUMMER HOURS
Wed. JULY 1st – Wed. Sept. 2nd

The last few years have seen some sharp increases in summer temperatures here on Gabriola which has made working conditions for GIRO staff and volunteers more challenging. In summer the temperatures on the dock by mid-afternoon (in the shade) can reach 42°C!

To help our staff manage the heat we will have **new summer hours starting Wednesday, July 1st.**

The depot (which includes the store) will be open from 8:30am – 3pm with the drive-in gate closing at 2:30pm.

Please make a note of this time change and we hope to see you bright and early!

We thank you in advance for your cooperation and support.

Kind regards,
Michelle Kresnyak, General Manager





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Sounder photo

THE GABRIOLA ELEMENTARY SCHOOL BANDS, under the direction of music teacher Rose Boulton, performed their year-end concert on June 16. They were joined by Gabriola Brass, as well as other Gabriola musicians who volunteer through the year to help teach the students. This year’s concert included the students playing a piece from the Star Wars soundtrack, in recognition of trombonist (and Gabriola resident) John Capon, who played on the soundtrack for A New Hope, the first of the Star Wars films.



Gabriola RECREATION SOCIETY

Registration and info for summer programs on GRS web site.
For info: 250-247-2014
info@gabriolarecreation.org

LEARN TO TRAIN SOCCER CAMP
(AGES 8-15) Soccer Camp where players are immersed in team-based skills and will participate in a more advanced program, the “Learn to Train” phase of development. Mon Jun 29 - Fri Jul 3

ROAR & EXPLORE WITH MRS. GURR
(AGES 4-8) Cooperative nature based projects and social skill-building experiences. Mon Jul 20 - Fri Jul 24
SOLD OUT! WAITLIST ONLY

SUMMER JAM
(AGES 6-12) Whether we are visiting playgrounds or making playgrounds out of our woods and trails nearby, we are sure to see and do something new every day. Mon Jul 20 - Fri Jul 24

NEW! LUCY’S BEACH CAMP
(AGES 8-14) Summer Leader Lucy R. returns to the island from her studies in Marine Biology at Dalhousie University to lead this exploration of five beaches and shorelines over five days! Mon Aug 10 - Fri Aug 14

THEATRE OF THE OUTDOORS CAMP
(AGES 9-12) Calling all junior thespians — bring your creativity, enthusiasm and full wonderful selves to learn acting and theatre skills. Mon Aug 17 - Fri Aug 21

UP & ATOM SCIENCE CAMP
(AGES 6-12) Get ready to have a blast with a science-based camp. Children will be presented a series of challenges to solve using basic materials, simple machines, and most importantly, their growing brains! Mon Jul 13 - Fri Jul 17

WIFFLE & T-BALL: LEARN TO PLAY
SOFTBALL (Ages 5-10) This four-session program (Mondays & Thursdays) uses light modified equipment and games to teach fundamental movement skills — throwing, catching, hitting — with an emphasis on fun. Mon Jul 6 - Thur Jul 16

COSTUMES & CHARACTERS CAMP
(AGES 7-10) A high energy, playful camp where children will explore self-expression through theatre games, costume creation, and collaborative storytelling. Mon Aug 3 - Fri Aug 7

CREATIVE ARTS CAMP
(AGES 6-12) Rooted in imagination and inspired by Gabriola’s natural beauty, this arts camp invites children to explore their creativity through a variety of mediums and themes. Mon Aug 24 - Fri Aug 28

FOREST GAMES CAMP
(AGES 6-12) Enjoy nature rambles, playground tours, and forest games such as Camouflage, Sandpeople, Ninja, and many more! Mon Jul 6 - Fri Jul 10

FUNDAMENTALS SOCCER CAMP
(AGES 6-12) Players will cultivate a love for the game and will be supported in their individual growth through technical and games-based activities, honing their agility, balance and coordination while working on team fundamentals. Mon Jul 27 - Fri Jul 31

HAPPY FEET SOCCER CAMP
(AGES 3-5) Fun soccer games and mini-sized sports to get active and practice various fundamental skills — running, jumping, throwing, catching, kicking and balancing. Mon Jul 27 - Fri Jul 31

JAY DEARMAN YOUTH FIREFIGHTER CAMP
(AGES 12-18) Learn about basic first aid, how to put out fires with extinguishers and how to prevent them with FireSmart, plus master ropes and knots! Tue Jul 7 - Thu Jul 16

www.gabriolarecreation.org





Sounder photo
THE GABRIOLA ELEMENTARY SCHOOL CHOIR at the year-end Band and Choir concert held on June 16.

Potato Cannon Contest

Canada Day, July 1st

Brickyard Beach, Gabriola

Firing starts at 1:00 p.m.

Rules:

- 1. Cannons must be made of plastic pipe
- 2. Hair spray or spray deodorant only for fuel
- 3. Bring your own potatoes for ammunition
- 4. Participants registration Opens at 12pm. Closes at 12:50pm.

Hosted by the Gabriola Rod, Gun and Conservation Club

Congratulations to the Grade 7 & Grade 12 graduates & their families!

“You’re on your own. And you know what you know. And you are the one who’ll decide where to go. You have brains in your head, you have feet in your shoes, you can steer yourself any direction you choose.”

~ Oh, the Places you’ll go. Dr. Seuss

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Let’s celebrate the volunteers cleaning up our beaches, working for reconciliation and welcoming newcomers to Canada. And let’s give thanks to those working on the holiday, the farmers that grow our food and people working to keep us safe. This Canada Day, let’s come together and give our country a true gift: a more fair and just Canada.

Happy Canada Day to you and your family!

My community office is here to help

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Sheila Malcolmson, MLA
Nanaimo - Gabriola

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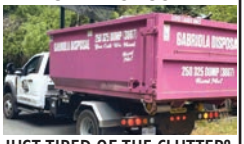
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GABRIOLA ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS. Open to all. Meets at Fellowship Church Sundays at 7pm, Wednesdays at 7pm, Fridays

at noon. Also Wednesdays at 9am, Community Hall, lower level. For details: 250-753-7513

AL ANON COURAGE TO CHANGE GROUP welcomes and gives comfort to families and friends of alcoholics. Contact 250-816-4135.

NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS at Gabriola Fellowship Church. Open meeting is Mondays

7pm to 8pm. Closed meeting is Thursdays 6pm to 7pm. Info: mysponsorsaidso@gmail.com

GABRIOLA PARKINSON’S SUPPORT AND EXERCISE GROUP. Meets Fridays 2:45 to 4pm at Rollo Centre. Caregivers welcome. For info, contact John Peirce, john.w.peirce@gmail.com, or call 250-247-8632.

Sounder Events Calendar

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UPCOMING EVENTS

Thu. June 25 - Gabriola Cruisers Car Club monthly meeting. Gabriola Golf Course. Join us for supper at 6pm. Meeting at 7pm.

Sat. June 27 and Sun. June 28 - Gabriola Quilters 2026 Quilt Show and Sale. 10am-4pm. Rollo Centre. 685 North Road. Free Admission, Door Prize, Wheelchair accessible.

Sun. June 28 - Shades of Masamba presents Saburo Murata & Friends. Latin Jazz. 2-4pm. Performers: Saburo Murata, Ian Cox, Kelly Field, Andreas Kahre, Voodoo Dave McGrath. Lund Gathering Place outside the Community Hall. Admission by donation.

Tue. June 30 - Family Caregivers Peer Support Group. Tuesdays 10am-11:30am, Fellowship Church. If you’ve never attended before, please call Jennifer at 250-896-8697.

Tue. June 30 - Grief Circle Support Group. Tuesdays 2:00pm-3:30, Fellowship Church. If you’ve never attended before, please call Jennifer at 250-896-8697.

Wed. July 1 - Canada Day Potato Cannons at Brickyard Beach. Registration closes at 12:30. Cannons fire at 1pm.

Wed. July 1 - Canada Day at Gabriola Museum. 2-4 pm. Opening Ceremony 2:15 pm. Activity tables, guessing games, colouring stations, giveaways, and more. Free museum admission & refreshments including cake! Indoor and outdoor exhibits open from 11 am to 4 pm. FMI: info@gabrielamuseum.org or visit gabrielamuseum.org/

Wed. July 1 - Sixth Annual July 1 Vintage and Speciality Vehicle Parade with the Gabriola Cruisers Auto Club. Starts at 10am. Route schedule in this June 24 *Sounder*. Non-members with vintage or other speciality vehicles invited to participate.

Sat July 4 - Munu Canoe fundraiser to support Snuneymuxw First Nation youth Tribal Journey. 10:30am - 3:30pm at x*cumi:lucun / Twin Beaches. Protocol, stories, dances, salmon and bannock lunch, paddle in a traditional canoe. Tickets: <https://tinyurl.com/munugabriola> or simply join us on July 4.

Sat. July 4 - International Day of Cooperatives 2026 “Cooperatives for a Peaceful World” 3-6 pm. Agi Hall- 465 South Rd - Learn about the many coops on Gabriola and celebrate working together for a more just and peaceful world. Speakers, presentations, art making, snacks and drinks. Everyone is welcome! Bring the kids in your life! Hosted by the Gabriola Agricultural Coop. FMI: coopagiassoc@gmail.com

Sat July 11 - Sun July 12 - GAC’s 8th Cultivate Performing and Arts Festival - Transatlantic Tides, Tunes, and Togetherness brings voices from home and away to the Commons Reservoir Stage. FMI: artsgabriola.ca/cultivate-festival

MARKETS

Saturdays - Farmer’s Market at the Agi. Hall. 10am-2pm. Producers. Food. Artisans. 465 South Rd.

Sundays - Silva Bay Market at Page’s Inn on Silva Bay. 11am - 3pm. 3415 South Road. Gabriolan Artisans, Food Vendors & Live Music!

REGULAR EVENTS

Saturdays - Do you want to learn more about gardening? Can’t tell a potato plan from a tomato plant? Want to get more out of your home veggie garden but not sure how? Come join Betty at the Gabriola Commons learning garden at 10am-12pm on Saturdays. It’s free (aside from some elbow grease); just show up. Get to know fellow islanders, help tend the various crops, and take some of what you’ve grown home as it comes ripe. FMI: email Betty at plumridgefarm@gmail.com.

Exhibit Omoide – Memories, Recollections and Reminiscences. Now open at the Gabriola Museum, Page’s Resort & Marina, and Page’s Inn on Silva Bay. A four-part exhibit honouring Japanese Canadian heritage on Gabriola. FMI: info@gabrielamuseum.org or gabrielamuseum.org/visit.

‘Living Out Loud: Queer Art on Gabriola’ - an art exhibition. This group art exhibition showcases the artwork of local artists from the LGBTQI2S+ community on Gabriola. On at Nova in Folklife until June 28.

“Between Desert & Sea: how it unfolds” - a new exhibition by John Konovsky, featuring the beauty, fragility and endurance of the Sonoran Desert of Baja California, Mexico. Downstairs at Gabriola Medical Centre, Monday-Friday until July 23.

Pier Gallery at Page’s Inn - Open Daily starting Friday June 26. 11am - 5pm.

Gabriola Drumming: Next three dates: Thu. June 25, Wed. July 1, Thu. July 9.
6pm – 7:30pm: Simple Rhythms – no experience needed. | 7:30 – 9pm: Intermediate African Ensemble Songs. Everyone welcome. No charge. Some Hand Drums/Balafons provided. Location: Gabriola Arts Centre.

Seniors Monthly Luncheon. Fourth Thursday of every month, 10:30am-12:30pm at Rollo Seniors Centre, Drop-in or Register Online! Luncheon to connect with friends in the community. Local entertainment, guest speakers, and seasonally themed events. Free.

Sundays - Join in reading through the Bible together. All are welcome at the Gabriola Fellowship Church. 4pm- 5:30pm. “Faith comes by hearing” *Romans 10:17*. Contact Jonathan 250-247-9767.

UPCOMING SLOPITCH GAMES AT ROLLO. Weekdays: Concession opens at 6. Games start at 6:30pm.

Wed. June 24: Ducky Field: Cornerstone at Wildflowers. Dogfish Field: Arbutus at Rockets.

Fri. June 26: Ducky Field: Beavers at Cornerstone. Dogfish Field: Arbutus at Surf.

Mon. June 29: Ducky Field: Wildflowers at Cornerstone. Dogfish Field: Rockets at Beavers.

AT THE GOLF COURSE: www.gabrielagolf.com

Clubhouse Hours - Open Mon to Fri: 11am-9pm. Sat and Sun: 9am to 5pm. **Mondays - Open Mic @ 6pm.**

Wednesdays - Games Night. 6pm at the Gabriola Golf Club. Poker, cards, board games with expanded menu.

Fridays - Burger and Darts Night at the Gabriola Golf Club. Burgers from 5pm. Darts from 7pm.

Sundays - Brunch at the Gabriola Golf Club. 9am - 12pm. Expanded breakfast menu and table service.

AT THE LIBRARY

On till June 27 Artist Rohana Laing presents “Celebrating Color” in the Library’s meeting room/gallery. Laing’s abstract stylized paintings reflect her love of textiles and many winters spent in San Miguel de Allende.

Sat. June 27 - “Getting Your Ducks in a Row: turning a business idea into reality.” Join Margot Fedoruk, Self-Employment Specialist with Entrepreneurs on the Rise for a practical & engaging workshop on starting a small business. No registration req’d. 3-4pm

Sat. July 4 - Sechelt author Jan DeGrass presents her latest book *Temptations and Travels* - “a collection of stories that wander freely between fiction and lived experience; tales of travels, trials and temptations.” 2-3pm

Thu. July 9 - Artist Reception for Doug Harrison. Join us in welcoming Doug and his beautiful evocative west coast paintings reflecting a lifetime of experiences working, exploring, and imagining the history of B.C.’s coasts. 5-7pm.

Family StoryTime on Saturdays. 11am-11:30am. All Ages.

Wednesdays - Shut Up & Write! 10am-12:30pm. A 2-hour session of silent writing. No discussions, just quick introductions then work silently on your writing project. Optional discussion period 12-12:30.

French Conversation Group - Venez parler français avec nous le jeudi, de 13 h à 14 h. Aucune préparation nécessaire. Tous les niveaux sont bienvenus. On parle de tout et de rien. Beginners welcome.

Tea Thursdays - All Day. Enjoy a cup of tea all day at the Library.

Open Mic Drop In at the Library. All writers are welcome to read their work aloud or just sit and listen. Readings are 5-10 minutes. Second and Last Friday of each month 12:30 – 2pm.

1st Saturday of every month - Death Café. 1-3pm. Discuss this natural part of life within a supportive group led by skilled facilitators Mary & Gary Holdgrafer. Cake & coffee by Ground Up cafe thanks to the Friends of the Gabriola Library. Registration required - call 247-7878

Gabriola LTC calls on community for rewrite of OCP vision statement

Hope Lompe
Local Journalism Initiative Reporter, Gabriola Sounder

The Gabriola Local Trust Committee (LTC) is calling on the community to re-write the Gabriola Official Community Plan Vision statement.

Speaking at the community OCP information meeting on May 21, Gabriola Trustee Tobi Elliott says the vision statement is too long and read as a compilation of all the things Gabriola wants to be. They are looking for a Gabriola community member to take on the task of a re-write. The draft vision statement was developed over the course of the OCP public engagement visioning and values process from 2023-2024.

In an email to the *Sounder*, Elliott says this vision state-

Draft OCP Vision Statement as it current reads:
“Gabriola Island is an active, resilient, inclusive, and sustainable rural community that respects Indigenous and local cultural heritage, protects the natural environment and biodiversity supports diverse housing and livelihoods, and works collaboratively to balance human needs within the Island’s ecological limits. The community fosters a strong sense of belonging and care, supporting diverse and affordable housing, accessible services, active and low-impact transportation, vibrant arts and culture, resilient local food systems and livelihoods, and collaborative action among residents, First Nations, and all levels of Government.”

ment should be written by those with a deep relationship to this island, who understand the spirit of this place as more than a grouping of individuals and a unique formation of geology, and who can cast a vision for our future.

She adds planners and the staff supporting the Gabriola OCP review have done an excellent job compiling the huge amount of information they heard from the community, however planners work

in the lexicon of bylaws and policies, not poetry.

“It doesn’t quite hit the mark of identifying what is special about Gabriola, the unique characteristics represent the spirit of this community and the island’s own distinct beauty, shaped over millennia by Snuneymuxw’s ancestors, and how we envision our collective future together,” she writes.

She adds there are many wordsmiths, writers, philosophers and thought-leaders on

Gabriola, and hopes someone can shape the draft vision into a statement that sings.

“We need to think bigger than Gabriola residents alone: how do we, together with Snuneymuxw peoples who will be living on the land again one day, envision our future together?”

Those interested can email the Islands Trust office on Gabriola at northinfo@islandstrust.bc.ca, or contact Gabriola Trustees Tobi Elliott or Susan Yates.



Derek Kilbourn photo

ISLAND XWSALUXUL started sailing the Gabriola route this past weekend. The vessel is one of two which were built for BC Ferries to run primarily as electric ferries (once charging stations are built at the terminals). *Island sarlequun* is expected to enter service on the route later this summer. The name xwsaluxul, meaning “the grassy place,” was gifted by the Snuneymuxw First Nation in the hul’qumi’num’ language and carries deep cultural and historical significance. These sacred grounds are connected to Snuneymuxw origin stories and hold an enduring relationship to the Nation’s lands, waters, and identity. The Snuneymuxw Sarlequun Treaty of 1854 was signed at xwsaluxul, further anchoring its importance within Snuneymuxw history.

Proposed affordable housing development incentive requires project be non-profit rental for the life of the building

Hope Lompe
Local Journalism Initiative Reporter, Gabriola Sounder

Affordable housing developers in EA B will need to prove their project will operate as non-profit rental housing for the life of the building if they want to take advantage of a proposed development cost charge (DCC) reduction bylaw.

DDCs are one-time fees charged to a developer to account for the additional strain on services and infrastructure, in this case parks services.

The proposed Parks DCC reduction bylaw would cut the fee in half for not-for-profit rental housing developers in EA B, intended to be an affordable housing development incentive.

A similar proposal went out for community input in December, as reported by the Sounder. The RDN Electoral Area Services Committee voted to rescind that version at its June 11 meeting, and replaced it with a version to safeguard an eligible project’s long-term use as non-profit rental housing.

This would need to be secured through a zoning

restriction and legal agreement and/or covenant with the federal or provincial governments, the B.C. Housing Management

Commission, Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation, or Islands Trust.

“It’s just an area of overlap between the Islands Trust and the RDN,” said EA B Director Vanessa Craig. She said she was interested in

ensuring that any agreement for the DCC reduction be done with the intention of the building being used for affordable rental housing for its lifetime.

“I asked for some additional research and wording and connection to potentially the Islands Trust,” she said.

“We do have an affordable housing development that’s just coming online now, and

they do have a covenant with the Islands Trust. I was interested in similar types of wording.”

The amended bylaw will be open for public feedback on the RDN’s Get Involved Page.

Have an opinion?
Write a letter.
Letters policy on page 4

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RDN staff give POSAC update on horse access to Petroglyph Trail

Trail widening considered over boardwalk replacement

Hope Lompe
Sounder News

Widening Petroglyph Trail to give horses through access is being considered by the Regional District of Nanaimo (RDN), as an alternative to reinforcing or rebuilding the boardwalks to accommodate horses.

As reported in the Feb. 25 *Sounder*, Electoral Area B’s Parks and Open Spaces Advisory Committee (POSAC) received correspondence from the Gabriola Horse Group at the Feb. 9 meeting.

Petroglyph Trail, which extends 3.2km behind Christ Church, became accessible to horses after the boardwalk was installed around 2006.

The group asked that the boardwalk be improved to

allow horses on the trail, or alternatively extend the trail on the side for horses to pass through. The later option is what the POSAC landed on at their June 1 meeting.

“Staff will monitor the Petroglyph Community Trail during the winter months to determine the environmental conditions and impacts of trail widening for horse access,” writes Rick Daykin, RDN Manager of Parks in an email to the *Sounder*.

“If the trail is deemed to be too wet during the winter months for horse access, staff will explore opportunities for widening the trail for dry trail access and post signage noting this as seasonal use only.”

The POSAC also noted they may reach out to

members of the community, including the Gabriola Horse Group, to help with the trail widening. This would entail trimming the brush on the right hand side.

Kerry Marcus, member of the Gabriola Horse Group and co-signer of the request letter, says they will see about a work party when the time comes. “This seems like the easiest and most sensible solution to adjust those areas to accommodate horses,” writes Marcus in an email to the *Sounder*.

“We spoke about this at our on-site RDN and Gabriola Land and Trails Trust (GaLTT) meeting a few weeks ago. A couple of areas are a bit challenging to clear but not impossible.”

Letters to the Editor continued from page 4

Since 2007, multiple households have raised ongoing concerns about noise generated by Summer Rain in a residential neighbourhood. These concerns persist because the noise issue has never been remedied.

In the summer, Summer Rain’s gas-powered pump runs up to 15 times per day, often for 15 to 20 minutes per cycle, along with truck idling and repeated departures and returns. This can amount to five hours of disturbance per day, seven days a week.

During this time, Mr. Foley has said publicly that he has spent \$50,000 in legal fees fighting the Islands Trust. He has also said he cannot use electric pumps because the power goes out. However, power outages on Gabriola are rare in the summer, and a gas pump could still be used during the occasional outage.

Before any enforcement or court action, neighbours attempted to resolve the issue directly and respectfully. Here is a message sent to Mr. Foley in 2022, after unsuccessful attempts to speak in person:

“I am writing to ask that you please look into muffling your pumps and/or switching to electric pumps. Your current pumps are extremely loud, and they disturb the enjoyment of my property. I know that there are quieter options, and I feel that the current volume is disrespectful to the other residents of this neighbourhood.

I understand that you run a business, I’m just asking that you make your pumps quieter so that the rest of the neighbourhood can enjoy their properties. Your neighbours and your workers will thank you.”

This message went unanswered. It was not a complaint to government. It was a polite request for basic noise mitigation.

The issue has never been about opposing water delivery.

~ Dylan Wallinger

I am disappointed to see the number of comments about Summer Rain both online and in letters to the editor that conflate water issues with what are Island Trust bylaw issues.

I won’t get into the ethical issues around selling water from wells on one’s property and the possible impacts on nearby neighbours from that activity. And I frankly don’t think that just because Dan is a nice guy he should be given a free pass on alleged Island Trust bylaw infringements if proven to be valid complaints.

The facts as I understand them from the Sounder articles are that at least 49 complaints have been made by several neighbours about alleged bylaw violations. Most of us understand and support the Islands Trust mandate to preserve and protect the “rural character” and ecosystem of our island. But I find it interesting that people often fail to recognize the role that Islands Trust plays in establishing and maintaining land use bylaws. It is the Islands Trust bylaw enforcement officer’s job to follow up on complaints by residents regarding conformity to Islands Trust land use bylaws. The fact that several neighbours have filed no less than 49 complaints regarding bylaw infringements with Islands Trust bylaw enforcement suggest by the sheer volume of complaints from different sources that there is an issue with Dan’s property in regard to conformity to Islands Trust regulations. The bylaw officer is simply doing his job by following up on complaints.

It is totally irrelevant whether Dan’s business provides what some consider an important community service. I might add that his business is not the only business on the Island capable of providing the services he offers. And it is also not relevant to the bylaw enforcement issue whenter Dan is a nice guy or not when it comes to bylaw conformity. Good neighbours in my opinion try not to negatively impact those who live close by. From what I have read in the Sounder, he does not appear to be concerned about some of the complaints and seems to be not too interested in addressing those complaints.

I find it most disappointing that some people in our community seem to be more than willing to conflate issues and denigrate individuals who are simply exercising their right as land owners and neighbours to raise complaints about a property that appears even to an informed resident to violate community standards of conformity to long standing land use bylaws. It is sad to see our community divided by conflation of issues and misinformation.

Sincerely,
~ Burrft Fidler

Sounder Alerts

When an emergency or a major event is happening, Sounder staff send out email alerts that include up-to-date information.

To be added to the list, email derek@soundernews.com with the subject line “Subscribe to Alerts”



Garden Club

Doug Smith
Sounder Contributor

When I was 16 and dinosaurs roamed the land my Dad came to me and told me I’d be joining the crew of a tugboat headed to Stewart B.C. with a barge load of heavy equipment in tow. Having been recently “retired” from my busboy job for the crime of pointing out the paint flecking off the prep table into the salads, I was excited about the opportunity to make a few bucks for the summer. At this point Dad told me I’d be paid in “experience.” Experience turned out to be standing at the top of the companionway to prevent the skipper’s 5 month

old son from rocketing down the stairs in his walker as the boat rolled its way through Queen Charlotte Sound. In fact young Tyler, who would be 46 now, became a source of entertainment rolling back and forth across the bridge deck.

That trip is an experience I wouldn’t trade for the world.

So what does this have to do with gardening you ask. Our fair island is awash in gardening knowledge and people who want to pass it on. So I’m writing today to encourage young Gabriolans who want to learn to grow their own food and flowers (because the other stuff is

legal now and that takes all the sport out of it) to consider a couple of options. Come to the next garden club meeting in September or reach out to the Community Seed Bank at gabeseedbank@gmail.com if you want to start at ground level. It’s never too late in the year. In fact we don’t plant winter crops for another few weeks. We hope you’ll take us up on this. We’ll find a way for you to get in touch with the soil in the way that best suits you. The experience is priceless.

TIDE GUIDE		
June 25 - July 1		
	Time	Feet
Thu. June 25	01:41	13.8
	09:34	4.0
	17:31	13.5
	21:48	12.0
Fri. June 26	02:11	13.4
	10:12	3.4
	18:16	14.2
	22:54	12.2
Sat. June 27	02:47	13.2
	10:50	3.1
	1853	14.6
	23:48	12.2
Sun. June 28	03:28	13.1
	11:28	2.8
	19:28	14.8
	00:31	12.2
Mon. June 29	04:13	13.1
	12:06	2.7
	20:02	15.0
	01:10	12.1
Tue. June 30	04:57	13.1
	12:32	2.7
	20:34	15.0
	01:48	11.9
Wed. July 1	05:40	13.0
	13:16	2.7
	21:04	15.1
Silva Bay/Thrasher Rock		
Hi Tide - 6 Minutes: .8 Feet		
Low Tide - 7 Minutes: .5 Feet		

SUDOKU

Answer on page 8

	1							
		5	6			9		
					8	1	7	2
		7	1					
			8	6				3
3				5		2		
1	3							
6	9			2	7		8	

The Sudoku Puzzle is played over a 9x9 grid, in each row there are 9 slots, some of them are empty and need to be filled. Each row, column and “area” (3*3) should contain the numbers 1 to 9, but: The number can appear only once on each row, once on each column & only once on each area (3*3 slots). The number should appear only once a row, column or area.

CROSSWORD

ANSWERS ON PAGE 8

CLUES ACROSS

1. Nocturnal S. American rodent
5. Requesting
11. Give temporarily
12. Excitedness
16. Armed Forces branch
17. Actor Harris
18. Middle Eastern capital
19. Air hostesses
24. Partner to “Pa”
25. Percussion instrument
26. Popular computers
27. Reduce light
28. Asian mountain range
29. Every one of two or more
30. Absence of difficulty
31. A public announcement of a proposed marriage
33. Whittles
34. Impact
38. Serviceman
39. A French river
40. Prehistoric people
43. Messenger ribonucleic acid
44. __ Clapton, musician
45. Ancient Greek sophist
49. Largest English dictionary (abbr.)
50. Singer Hansard
51. A way to disentangle
53. Atomic #93
54. Manifesting approval
56. Indigo bush
58. Former AL MVP Vaughn
59. Off-Broadway theater award
60. Fencers
63. Small Eurasian deer (pl.)
64. Relating to passerine birds
65. Arrange systematically

CLUES DOWN

1. Colorless fluid
2. Of a main artery
3. Photographer’s tool
4. Blues Traveler hit “But __”
5. Grew older
6. Not the leader
7. __ Lang (country singer)
8. A driver’s license is one
9. Nests of pheasants
10. Wildebeests
13. Equal to one quintillion bytes
14. Japanese three-stringed lute
15. Type of cat
20. It cools your home
21. The ancient Egyptian sun god
22. Pouches
23. German trigraph
27. Form of Persian
29. Measurement unit
30. Body part
31. Bridge building degree
32. Indicates position
33. Political action committee
34. Snack food

1	2	3	4		5	6	7	8	9	10			
11					12					13	14	15	
16					17				18				
19				20	21		22	23			24		
25						26					27		
28					29					30			
				31	32				33				
34	35	36	37					38					
39					40	41	42						
43					44					45	46	47	48
49				50				51	52				
53			54					55					
56		57				58				59			
60					61	62				63			
			64							65			

Obituaries



Cellik
Joan Agnew (nee Groves)

Joan passed peacefully on April 23 with strength and gratitude. She loved her full life and had no regrets. The positivity and joy she radiated throughout her life was with her right to the end. She is survived by her husband, Steve; her children, Peter and his wife EJ, and Wendy; and her grandsons, Raiden and Atom.

Joan, Joanie, Joan of the North, Mom, Neni was passionate about meditation and yoga and found peace in her practice.

A long-time and very active member of the Gabriola community for nearly 50 years, Joan loved her friends, neighbours,

and the magical beauty of Gabriola. She spent countless happy hours swimming in the ocean and walking in the woods.

Her family will be holding a small private ceremony. We would sincerely like to thank all the wonderful medical professionals on Gabriola and in Victoria and Nanaimo who took such good care of her during her battle with ovarian cancer.

Anyone wishing to honour Joan's memory is invited to direct their support to the Canadian Cancer Society.

You were light and love. We miss you terribly, but also know you are watching over us.



Tracey Maureen Dorman
April 25, 1957- May 18, 2026

A Beautiful Soul, is now soaring with the Angels on a new journey of Bliss and Joy... Too Young, Too Soon.

Tracey and Dean met in Nanaimo 25 years ago and moved to Gabriola 20 years ago. Tracey grew up in Harewood, Nanaimo, with her siblings, Gail, Sandra, and Shane. In Grade One she met her lifelong friend and bestie, Leanne McWhinney (Leanne's hubby, Ron Frank became a great friend, too) . Her parents, now deceased, were Faye Dorman (nee Collins) and Reg Dorman of Nanaimo. She is survived by her daughter, Tessa Dorman-Kotzer, and her loving spouse, Dean Nikkel.

She had terrific memories of herself and Leanne riding their horses, Candy and Lady, and long summer days at their family cabin at Cameron Lake.

One of Tracey's enduring passions in life was art, and she was in her happy place exploring and creating.

She was also passionate about animals, both domestic and wild. Amongst her favorites are two very loving and special cats, Bella and Gigi, and the thoroughbred, Libby, and our mini horse, Lilly. Others included, Nappy, Cleo, Oscar, Freckles, Chloe, our faithful black lab, "Jessie" , and her little cohort, "Ricky".

Tracey's spirit shines brightly through her beautiful daughter, Tessa. This can be witnessed in her smile, character, strength, wisdom, love of animals, and passion for art.

A huge Thank You to the Doctors, Nurses and Home Support Folks of Gabriola and the most wonderful staff at the NRGH Palliative unit. You truly helped our transition with your kindness, professionalism and love.

Dean says, "Tracey taught me about the giving and receiving of love. She taught me how to love."

In honour of Tracey's memory, please hug your loved one an extra second or two, be calm, be kind, and be happy.

Smile at strangers and take a minute with Mother Earth. Leave them with
A wink
A smile
And a kiss.

A Celebration of Tracey's life and art will be held Sunday, August 23, from 2-5pm, at the Gabriola Golf Club.



Anthony (Tony) Vickers
Oct. 6, 1944 - June 3, 2026

Anthony (Tony) Vickers arrived into this world in Huddersfield, Yorkshire on 6 October 1944, and left it on 3 June 2026 as a proud resident of Gabriola Island.

He is survived by his wife and best audience, Janet; his children Geoff (Linda), Elaine (Terry) and Karen (Simon); his grandchildren

Elyssa, Liam, Lucas and Gabriel; and twin sisters Annie and Judith. He is also survived by a Liverpool FC scarf and a well-seasoned scotch glass.

Tony had many loves: family, soccer, food and gardening, to name a few, which he applied himself to with equal dedication and a martini in hand when conditions allowed. He played soccer into his 60's, coached here on Gabriola into his 70s, and was a staunch Liverpool supporter. He was known island-wide for his kindness, his sense of humour, and his inexhaustible supply of jokes (most of which you had already heard). He will be greatly missed and forever cherished, but of course, "*we will never walk alone.*" (the Liverpool FC slogan)

A celebration of Tony's

life will be held on June 28th, 2026. Please email vickerskaren@hotmail.com if you knew Tony and would like to attend. In lieu of flow-

ers, the family suggests you cook something wonderful, eat it slowly, and if you know a good Yorkshire joke, tell it twice.



In Memory of
Charlie Blackburn

The Blackburn family will be hosting an informal get-together at 1146 Jeanette Avenue Saturday, July 4, 2026 in remembrance of Charlie Blackburn who sadly passed away March 6, 2026 after a long and thoroughly enjoyable life.

His friends on the island are invited to drop by anytime between 2-5 pm.

Fire Rating now at Extreme Shutdown

Please check the list below of requirements for permitted activities under this rating.

If a major wildfire or any other emergency happens on Gabriola, alerts will be sent out via the Regional District of Nanaimo's Voyent alert system. Residents can choose to receive alerts via the Voyent App, by text messaging, email, or landline phones. Sign up at rdn.bc.ca/rdn-alerts or scan this QR----->

Know your Evacuation plan: the RDN has complete evacuation plans in place for 13 zones covering Gabriola, Mudge, and DeCourcy islands. Residents are encouraged by the RDN and Gabriola Fire to learn what zone they live in, and what resources and instructions are in place for that zone, should an emergency occur.

Find the Area B evacuation plan on the RDN website at rdn.bc.ca/evacuation-plans or scan this QR-->



FIRE HAZARD CHART
Gabriola Volunteer Fire Department



TABLES FOR RESIDENTIAL AND INDUSTRIAL ACTIVITIES (Updated June 12, 2026)

RESIDENTIAL ACTIVITIES	LOW MOD	HIGH	HIGH EARLY SHIFT	EXTREME EARLY SHIFT	Extreme SHUTDOWN
PROPANE FIRE PIT (6" Flame Max)	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with
BBQs Hibachi, Propane, or Char. BBQ	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with
GENERATORS/PUMPS Portable Gas Generator Water Pump	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with
ELECTRIC/BATTERY Leaf Blowing, String Trimming, Pressure Washer, etc.	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with
GAS POWERED Leaf Blowing, String Trimming, Pressure Washer, etc.	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with
LAWN MOWING Electric and Gas Powered Scythes	YES	YES	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	IRRIGATED LAWNS ONLY
CARPENTRY TOOLS (i.e. skills saws, sanders, jigsaws, etc.)	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with

2 HOUR WATCH

2 HR WATCH

PHONE REQUIRED

FIRE EXTINGUISHER
(ABC 5 lb)

WATER SOURCE
Such as well, garden hose, or 250 gal+ (946L+) storage tank, etc.

FIRE FIGHTING EQUIPMENT
HOSE
38mm (1.5")
GAS POWERED PUMP
151L/min (40 gal/min)
WATER SOURCE
946L+ (250gal+)
HAND TOOLS

INDUSTRIAL ACTIVITIES	LOW MOD	HIGH	HIGH EARLY SHIFT	EXTREME EARLY SHIFT	Extreme SHUTDOWN
GENERATORS/PUMPS Portable Gas Generator Water Pump	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with
EXCAVATING & DRILLING Well & Rock Drilling/Jackhammering Non-Combustible Area	YES	YES	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with	YES ALL DAY with
TREE & BUSH REMOVAL/TREE PROCESSING/MILLING	YES	YES	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	NO
CHAINSAWS Electric/Gas Powered	YES	YES	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	NO
METAL WORK Grinding/Cutting Metal/Welding (Outdoors)	YES	YES	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	NO
EXPLOSIVES	YES	YES	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	ONLY UNTIL 1 pm with	NO
BURN BARRELS	YES	YES*	NO	NO	NO

* NO BURN BARRELS WHEN PROVINCIAL OR LOCAL BAN IS IN EFFECT. ** AFTER 1 pm add FIREFIGHTER EQUIPMENT

2 HOUR WATCH

2 HR WATCH

PHONE REQUIRED

FIRE EXTINGUISHER
(ABC 5 lb)

WATER SOURCE
Such as well, garden hose, or 250 gal+ (946L+) storage tank, etc.

FIRE FIGHTING EQUIPMENT
HOSE
38mm (1.5")
GAS POWERED PUMP
151L/min (40 gal/min)
WATER SOURCE
946L+ (250gal+)
HAND TOOLS

OBITUARIES

To submit an Obituary, please contact Derek or Sarah at the Sounder at 250-247-9337 or derek@soundernews.com

Or bring into the Sounder office to discuss

Deadline to submit is noon on the Friday prior to desired publication date.

carly & robyn

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and island visitors a
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C'tasi:a Geraldine Manson retires from VIU after 18 years

Manson reflects on her time in conversation with the Sounder

Hope Lompe
Sounder News

Following in the footsteps of the late Elder Ellen White, C'tasi:a Geraldine Manson walked through the doors of Vancouver Island University (VIU) in what would become an 18 year career as their Elder in residence.

During this time, Manson would create presentations for students in classrooms, and provide teaching about the Coast Salish people, and provide guidance for those entering the work force on how to interact with Indigenous populations.

Manson had her last day at VIU on April 30 and was thrown a well-attended retirement party on May 21.

"I was full of anxiety, because my gosh, who's gonna show up?" she said. "When I entered, seeing all my friends and colleagues fill that space...it was amazing."

She shared that an old colleague did a song for her, and students shared how her role made an impact in their lives, as well as the past VIU president.

"I am honored to know that my role there made a difference, and to see the past president come and share a few words for me, and I was honored, really honored," she said.

She says some of the biggest highlights from her in the last 18 years was learning from White, who she called "Auntie Ellen."

"I always remember Auntie Ellen's words, saying, you speak and you speak the truth. There may be those who don't want to hear the truth, but you speak it, and don't let anybody silent you," said Manson.

"Now those individuals who stood in the back watching me are the very individuals who now surround me."

Manson is a Snuneymuxw Elder and Knowledge keeper. She recalls being on Gabriola Island at 19 years old, taking a walk with three elders who were teaching her about the petroglyphs, in preparation for her future role.

"One of the elders turned around, looked at me, and said, 'It's time for you to sober up.' I looked at him with a blank stare, and the other elder turned around [asking], 'Do you know what he means Honey?'"

"I said not really.

"The other elder said, 'It's time for your mind to open up, because you're the only one sitting here with us, the only one walking the land with us. Everything we showed you, talked to you about, these images, you're the one that's holding it now.'"

Manson says she is retiring

from the role to make more room to serve her community in other ways.

"I am still busy, but I'm using my gifts in other capacities, and it frees me up," she said. Among several things, she is involved in several roles as an Elder including the school district, and B.C. First Nations Justice Council.

"I'm coming back into the community, I'm working with youth and supporting youth that are struggling, I'm taking people back onto the land and talking about the importance of the land."

Sounder photo

ELDER C'TASI:A GERALDINE MANSON (RIGHT) with Sheila Malcolmson (MLA Gabriola-Nanaimo) at kw'atl'kwu/World Ocean Day earlier this month.



HAPPY
Canada
DAY

Gabriola Cruisers Auto Club

will be holding our
6th Annual Vintage &
Specialty Vehicle Parade
around the island on
Canada Day.

July 1 Parade Route

Gabrielans are encouraged to come out with a comfy lawn chair at a safe viewing location, & cheer us on. You can judge for yourselves when we'll be driving by, keep you eyes and ears tuned to a street near you.

We start at 10am and plan to finish around 11:30am.

9am: Muster at Twin Beaches (Gabriola Sands Provincial Park)

10am: Depart Twin Beaches

Left turn on to Berry Point Rd, past the Medical Centre on Church St. and stop at North Rd. Left on North Rd.

Turn left on Barrett to Whalebone. Follow Whalebone and turn left on to Tashtego Crescent. Reaching Whalebone again, turn right and return to Barrett to North Road and turn Left.

Follow North Road to Silva Bay and South Road to El Verano.

Turn left on to El Verano, follow, turn left back on to South Road.

South Rd to Dirksen, turn left, follow to Stephens and a right turn at Pat Burns Ave.

Right on Penty. Right on to Duthie. Left on Stephens Rd, follow to Dirksen to South Road.

Left on South Road, right on Taylor Bay to Twin Beaches Park.

End time approximately 11:30am

Driver Information:

Please stay legally close to the car in front of you to avoid falling behind, getting lost etc. The parade will be conducted obeying all traffic laws. We will pause from time to time for anyone who needs to catch up. Gabrielans who are not members of the Cruisers Club yet, who have vintage or other specialty vehicles are invited to participate in the parade.

Decorated cars are encouraged!



GABRIOLA
Cruisers
AUTO CLUB

Our next Cruisers meetings are:

June 25 & July 30. Join us for
6pm supper, 7pm meeting at the
Gabriola Golf and Country Club.



FIRE
BAN



A FIRE BAN IS IN EFFECT
ON GABRIOLA ISLAND



NO CAMPFIRES



NO OPEN BURNING



NO FIREWORKS

This fire ban helps protect our community, our firefighters, our environment and our island.

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